

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Azure Cloud Security | Microsoft 365 | EDR | Hybrid Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience strengthening security across hybrid infrastructure and Azure cloud environments in large, complex organisations. I specialise in protecting Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 (M365) environments, delivering end-to-end security engineering across cloud identity, endpoint, email, and data workloads. I have extensive hands-on experience deploying and operating CrowdStrike Falcon for Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across an 8,000-user organisation. I am skilled in configuring Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), and Privileged Access Management (PAM) to secure identities and reduce the attack surface across hybrid on-premises and cloud environments. I bring strong expertise in vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and AppCheck, with experience driving remediation programmes aligned to business risk. I am a confident remote worker with a track record of delivering security improvements autonomously and collaborating effectively with distributed teams across IT infrastructure, engineering, and senior leadership.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Cloud Security (Azure and M365):** Microsoft Azure security controls, Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, Conditional Access, Entra ID protection, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); threat hunting, alert triage, and containment
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language / KQL), SOAR playbook development and automation, CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, detection engineering
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory, Conditional Access policies, MFA, SSO, Group Policy, Privileged Access Management (PAM) with BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera BAS; vulnerability scanning, risk-based prioritisation, and remediation tracking
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast email gateway, anti-phishing, Data Loss Prevention (DLP), web content filtering and SSL inspection
- **Mobile Device and Application Management:** Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policy configuration across hybrid device estates
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, incident playbooks, digital forensics triage, business continuity coordination
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR automation, Azure Logic Apps
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cyber Security Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Strengthen security across a hybrid infrastructure and cloud environment for a large multi-site organisation, securing over 8,000 users across Azure, Microsoft 365, and on-premises systems
- Lead the design, implementation, and continuous improvement of Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 security controls, including Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for Cloud Apps, and Conditional Access policies

- Manage and operate CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the full endpoint estate, conducting proactive threat hunting using Falcon Insight, tuning prevention policies, and leading endpoint incident response and containment
- Engineer and maintain Microsoft Sentinel SIEM detection rules using KQL, building SOAR playbook automation to accelerate triage and response for high-priority security events
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policy design, MFA rollout, SSO federation, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and Just-in-Time (JIT) access controls
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM to enforce least-privilege access principles across all administrative and privileged accounts in the hybrid environment
- Oversee vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, running regular scanning cycles across cloud and on-premises assets and driving remediation with infrastructure and application teams
- Configure and manage Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM to enforce device compliance policies across corporate endpoints and remote-worker devices
- Maintain Mimecast email security gateway policies and lead response to email-borne threats including phishing, business email compromise (BEC), and malware campaigns
- Produce management-level security reporting and contribute to governance documentation aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus frameworks

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Supported full deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate, onboarding endpoints and servers and configuring baseline detection and response policies
- Conducted daily alert triage across Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, CrowdStrike Falcon, and Mimecast, investigating and resolving security incidents within agreed Service Level Agreement (SLA) timeframes
- Developed and maintained SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps and API integrations to reduce manual investigation effort and accelerate containment
- Performed regular vulnerability scanning using Nessus and AppCheck across web applications and infrastructure, producing risk-rated remediation reports for infrastructure and application owners
- Managed Azure Active Directory user lifecycle, group membership, Conditional Access policies, and MFA configuration for staff and student populations
- Administered the Tanium endpoint management platform for real-time software inventory, patch status visibility, and rapid deployment of emergency patches
- Supported delivery of Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation by coordinating evidence gathering and remediation activities across multiple IT teams
- Contributed to security awareness training programmes to educate staff on phishing recognition, safe cloud storage practices, and remote working security

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Secured a cloud-first SaaS platform environment, implementing and managing endpoint security controls, patch management, and device hardening aligned to CIS Benchmarks
- Administered Microsoft Azure Active Directory including user provisioning, MFA deployment, Conditional Access policies, and SSO configuration for SaaS applications
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM for all corporate and remote worker endpoints, enforcing compliance baselines and application control policies
- Assisted with vulnerability management scanning, triaging findings, and coordinating remediation with development and infrastructure teams to maintain a strong security posture
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline Azure Active Directory administration, device compliance reporting, and routine security operations tasks
- Maintained security documentation including risk registers, incident response playbooks, and access control policies aligned to ISO 27001 requirements

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led end-to-end deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across an 8,000-user hybrid estate, achieving full coverage and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) for endpoint threats by 40%
- Engineered a library of over 30 Microsoft Sentinel SOAR automation playbooks, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-severity cloud and endpoint incidents from four hours to under 45 minutes
- Designed and implemented a comprehensive Microsoft Azure and M365 security hardening programme, improving the organisation's Microsoft Secure Score by over 30 percentage points
- Delivered Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) programme across hybrid infrastructure, identifying and driving remediation of 120+ critical and high-severity vulnerabilities
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification for three consecutive years, coordinating cross-team evidence collection and ensuring continuous compliance with the framework
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM across all privileged accounts in the hybrid environment, eliminating standing administrative access and achieving alignment with CIS Control 5

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)